

Tragelaphus gratus

Western Sitatunga



Length 4–5½ ft
(1.2–1.7 m)
Tail 9¼–17 in
(24–43 cm)
Weight 110–280 lb
(50–125 kg)
Location W. and C. Africa
Social unit Variable
Status Least concern

Amphibious in habit, the western sitatunga occurs in permanent swamps, marshes, and similar watery habitats. Its long, pointed, widely splayed hooves and extremely flexible foot joints are specialized for soft, muddy ground. When in danger from a land-based predator, this antelope retreats to water, and may submerge with only its eyes and nose exposed. At night, males bark warnings or avoidance calls to other males; if they meet, they

posture and “horn” the ground. The sitatunga eats many kinds of aquatic and terrestrial plants, including reeds, grasses, and shrubby foliage. While feeding, it may stand in water up to its shoulders. Only the male has ridged, spiraling horns. It also has a grayish tinge to its coat, while the female's is brown to chestnut; both sexes have white around the eyes, and on the cheeks and body. Males are solitary, while females are more social and may live in groups of up to 3. The single calf (rarely twins) is born after 247 days' gestation. There is no specific breeding season.



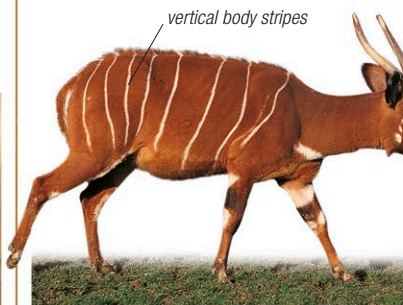
Tragelaphus euryceros

Bongo



Length 7¼–7¾ ft
(2.2–2.3 m)
Tail 18–26 in
(45–65 cm)
Weight 460–890 lb
(210–405 kg)
Location W. and C. Africa
Social unit Individual/Group
Status Near threatened

The largest and most distinctive forest antelope, the bongo has vertical white stripes along the body, and a white chest crescent, cheek spots, nose chevron, and leg bands. The coat is chestnut above, darker below, and it darkens in older males. This selective browser has lyre-shaped horns, longer (up to 37 in/95 cm) in the male, who is solitary. Females form herds of up to 50, perhaps coalescing as their calves associate into nursery bands.

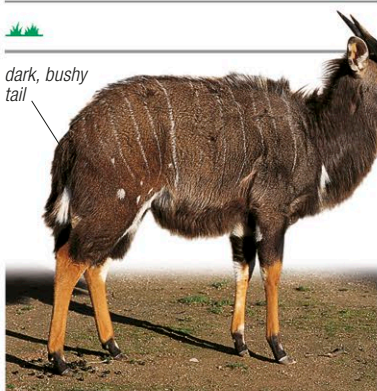


Tragelaphus angasii

Nyala



Length 4¼–6¼ ft
(1.3–1.9 m)
Tail 13¼–16 in
(34–40 cm)
Weight 120–280 lb
(55–125 kg)
Location Southern Africa
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



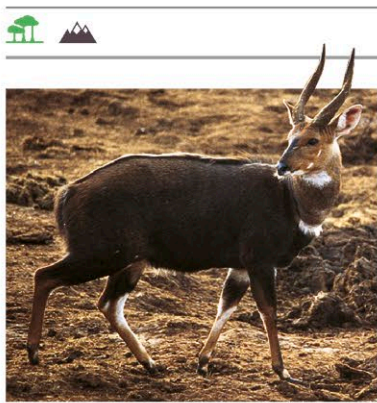
The male nyala is larger and heavier than the female, with a charcoal-gray head and body, indistinct body stripes, tan lower legs, and horns up to 28 in (70 cm) long. Females have no horns and, like juveniles, are red-brown, with a white “V” between the eyes, and vertical white body stripes. Nyalas prefer dense bush near water, and both graze and browse, rearing up to reach higher leaves.

Tragelaphus menelikii

Bushbuck



Length 3½–4½ ft
(1.1–1.4 m)
Tail 7¼–9¼ in
(19–24 cm)
Weight 50–185 lb
(24–85 kg)
Location Ethiopia
Social unit Individual
Status Least concern



The bushbuck resembles a small sitatunga (see above), with less twisted horns. Females from bush-dwelling populations are pale tawny; those in forests are redder. Males are dark brown to black with white markings on the legs, neck, and head; females are pale red in color with white markings that may include spots on the flanks. This antelope is a browser and solitary, except when courting or when a mother is with her young.

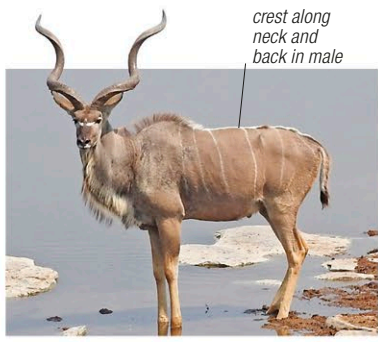
Strepsiceros zambiensis

Zambesi kudu



Length 6½–8¼ ft
(2–2.5 m)
Tail 16–29½ in
(41–75 cm)
Weight 260–690 lb
(120–315 kg)
Location S.W., S.C., and S.E. Africa
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

The male zambesi kudu is one of the tallest and longest-horned (average 5½ ft/1.7 m) antelopes, and has a long throat fringe. Coloration in both sexes is gray-tinged red or brown, with 6–10 white body stripes, and white nose and cheek marks. This kudu eats leaves, flowers, fruit, herbs, and tubers. Females form groups of up to 6, as do males, except when they compete during the breeding season.



Taurotragus oryx

Common eland



Length 7–11 ft
(2.1–3.5 m)
Tail 23½–35 in
(60–90 cm)
Weight 660–2,210 lb
(300–1,000 kg)
Location C. E. and southern Africa
Social unit Variable
Status Least concern

The two species of eland are the biggest, most cowlike antelopes. Male common elands can weigh up to 2,210 lb (1,000 kg), and have spiraling horns up to 4 ft (1.2 m) long, and a brown-black “topknot” of matted hair on the head. Females weigh up to 1,320 lb (600 kg), with horns half the length of those of the male. Overall body



proportions resemble cattle more than antelopes. Also in the manner of cattle, females band together to defend young and repel predators such as lions. The common eland browses in bush, plains and open woodland. It gathers food with its lips, and digs up bulbs and tubers with its hooves. Like the camel, it allows its body temperature to rise by up to 13°F (7°C) to avoid losing water as sweat, and thereby survives drought. Herds usually consist mainly of females with calves and juveniles; older males may be solitary. These antelopes are relatively docile and are kept for meat, milk, and hides in Africa. They are also exported to regions such as Asia.

WHITE STRIPES
Common eland are mainly grayish fawn, with a black stripe along the center of the back, and up to 15 whitish cream vertical body stripes.